Control Data With Targeted Refusals

Experiment index

Question and Context

Could explicit refusal examples reduce unsupported actions when early control training still rarely refused?

Setup

Refusal-focused synthetic examples were added to the control-data path. A full 50-case evaluation and later seven-case prompt diagnostics survive.

The seven-case outputs are refusal-only diagnostics, not 50-case benchmarks. Some of those tests changed the inference prompt or parser; their numbers must not be attributed solely to training.

Results

Evaluation	Cases	Task success	Tool accuracy	Argument accuracy	Clarification wording	Refusal wording
Targeted refusals	50	12/50 (0.240)	0.500	0.759	0.111	0.143
Targeted refusals / prompt-only	7	0/7 (0.000)	0.429	1.000	n/a	0.000
Control / policy prompt	7	0/7 (0.000)	0.429	1.000	n/a	0.071
Control / policy prompt / early parser fix	7	1/7 (0.143)	0.429	1.000	n/a	0.143

Values are ratios from 0 to 1, rounded to three decimals. Clarification/refusal columns measure wording criteria, not routing alone. Different suite sizes remain separate evaluations.

Result Provenance

- Targeted refusals: 2026-08-22 UTC, 50 cases.
- Targeted refusals / prompt-only: 2026-09-15 UTC, 7 cases.
- Control / policy prompt: 2026-09-15 UTC, 7 cases.
- Control / policy prompt / early parser fix: 2026-09-15 UTC, 7 cases.

Interpretation

The full run completed 12/50 tasks and had refusal wording accuracy 0.143. Most seven-case diagnostics still recorded no strict task success; the later policy-prompt/parser-fix diagnostic recorded one.

Giving the model refusal examples did not by itself resolve boundary routing or explanation quality.

Limits

The saved files do not fully recover the authored-data changes or repeat counts. Single-class subset rates cannot establish balanced ACT/CLARIFY/REFUSE performance. Parser and prompt changes are additional variables.

Supporting Files

The result links above are the surviving primary evidence. A separate immutable training record was not established for this historical experiment.

Notes assembled on 2026-10-10 from saved artifacts and repository records. No training, inference or result modification was performed to write this note.

PDF exported 2026-10-12. Original Markdown and benchmark evidence are preserved. Local artifact links require the project files.